

1968

JANUARY 5

Operation Niagara I begins, seeking intelligence about the movement of NVA forces threatening the Khe Sanh Marine base in northern South Vietnam.

JANUARY 21

The NVA besieges the Khe Sanh Marine base. The US responds with an aerial resupply of the base and bombardment of NVA positions.



Marine Corps patch

JANUARY 30–31

North Vietnam launches the Tet Offensive. Viet Cong guerrillas and NVA troops carry out attacks in cities and towns across South Vietnam, including Hue and Saigon, where they penetrate the US Embassy compound.